H Helpset

Printable Reading Rulers

Three kinds of reading ruler to print at home or school — free, no login.

1. Window reading rulers

Pages 2–3

A card strip with a slot cut out. Lay it on the page so one line shows through the window and the lines above and below are covered. Page 2 has a slot for standard print; page 3 has a wider slot for large print and children's books. Print on paper or thin card.

2. Line trackers

Page 4

Coloured strips to slide down the page underneath the line you are reading. The strong top edge keeps your eyes on the line. Print on paper or card — no cutting out windows.

3. Coloured overlay strips

Page 5

Tinted strips for readers who find a colour makes text more comfortable. These only work as overlays if you print them on transparency (acetate) film made for your printer — on paper they are just colour samples, which can still help you choose a colour.

Printing and making tips

- Print at 100% / Actual size (not 'Fit to page') so the centimetre scale and slot sizes stay accurate.
- Thin card (160–220gsm) makes rulers that last. Laminating helps too — cut the window out before laminating, then trim the laminate inside the window.
- To cut a window: fold the strip gently across the middle of the slot, snip into the fold, then cut round the dotted line. A craft knife on a cutting mat is neater (adults only).
- Let the reader try a few colours. There is no single best colour, and plenty of people prefer grey or no colour at all.
- A reading ruler is a reading aid, not a treatment for dyslexia. If visual stress is suspected, an optometrist can carry out a proper colour assessment.

© Helpset. Free to print and share for personal, classroom and therapy use. Please don't sell it.
Want a reading ruler for screens? Try the free online version at helpset.uk/reading-ruler

Helpset

Window reading rulers — standard print

Cut round the strip, then cut out the white window. One line of a typical book shows through.

Reading ruler Yellow · standard slot

cut out this window



Reading ruler Blue · standard slot

cut out this window



Reading ruler Green · standard slot

cut out this window



Reading ruler Pink · standard slot

cut out this window



Reading ruler Lavender · standard slot

cut out this window



Helpset

Window reading rulers — large print

A taller window for large-print books, early readers and worksheets with bigger text.

Reading ruler Peach · large slot

cut out this window



Reading ruler Grey · large slot

cut out this window



Reading ruler Yellow · large slot

cut out this window



Reading ruler Blue · large slot

cut out this window



Reading ruler Green · large slot

cut out this window



Helpset

Line trackers

Slide the strip down the page, keeping its dark top edge just under the line you're reading.

Line tracker

Yellow · keep the dark edge under your line



Line tracker

Blue · keep the dark edge under your line



Line tracker

Green · keep the dark edge under your line



Line tracker

Pink · keep the dark edge under your line



Line tracker

Lavender · keep the dark edge under your line



Line tracker

Peach · keep the dark edge under your line



Line tracker

Grey · keep the dark edge under your line



Free from helpset.uk/reading-ruler

Helpset

Coloured overlay strips

Print this page on transparency (acetate) film, then cut out and lay a strip over the text.

Use film made for your printer type (inkjet or laser). On ordinary paper these are colour samples only.

Yellow overlay

Blue overlay

Green overlay

Pink overlay

Lavender overlay

Peach overlay

Grey overlay

Free from helpset.uk/reading-ruler